

Logistics Market Intelligence Report Air

Monthly Report | Sep 2026



SAMSUNG SDS

Contents

1. Executive Summary	1
2. Air Market Trends.....	2
Demand Trends.....	2
Major Airport Cargo Throughput	3
Supply Trends.....	4
3. Air Market Outlook & Freight Index Trends	5
Air Freight Composite Index and Route Trend Analysis	5
Samsung SDS Short Term Forecast.....	5



1. Executive Summary

Demand

- July demand increased 4.7% YoY (up 1.4% MoM), sustaining growth. A modal shift from surging transpacific ocean freight rates, combined with semiconductor/AI server cargo demand, drove the gains
- August demand steadied after a typhoon-driven, temporary dip at major Chinese airports; Europe-bound e-commerce declines eased gradually, but seasonal slack softened demand 3-6% across all regions vs. the prior two weeks
- Asia- and North America-bound demand was supported by semiconductor/AI server cargo, while MEIA-bound demand was supported by India-origin cargo, keeping YoY growth at 4-7%

Supply

- July supply increased 1.8% YoY, trailing demand growth; Asia-Pacific carriers accounted for about 74% of the total increase, concentrating capacity additions
- August supply rose 0.4% YoY; passenger aircraft capacity was flat, while freighter capacity expansion drove overall supply growth
*Based on weeks 33-34, 7/27-8/9 vs. 8/10-8/23
- Asia-origin supply rose on added Taiwan- and Incheon-origin freighter capacity, but perceived Europe-bound supply tightness persisted on China- and Hong Kong-origin flight cuts, while South Asia saw a sharp expansion in India-origin freighter capacity

Freight Rates

- The week 35 Baltic Air Freight Index reached 2,419, down 0.2% WoW but 21.0% higher YoY
- The August average index was 2,422, down 1.5% MoM and up 19.1% YoY, extending the high-rate off-peak-season phase
- September-October rates are expected to edge up as the decline steadies, with strong Asia-origin semiconductor demand and high North America-bound rates persisting alongside a China/Hong Kong-Europe rate recovery and peak-season effects, and elevated India-origin premiums



2. Air Market Trends

Demand Trends

○ July 2026 Demand Trends

- July demand rose 4.7% YoY (up 1.4% MoM), sustaining growth. A modal shift from surging transpacific ocean freight rates, combined with Asia/N.A-bound semiconductor and AI server cargo, expanded air demand
- Dedicated freighter volume rose 13.9% YoY, the largest increase in 5 years, while passenger (Belly) cargo volume fell 7.0% YoY¹

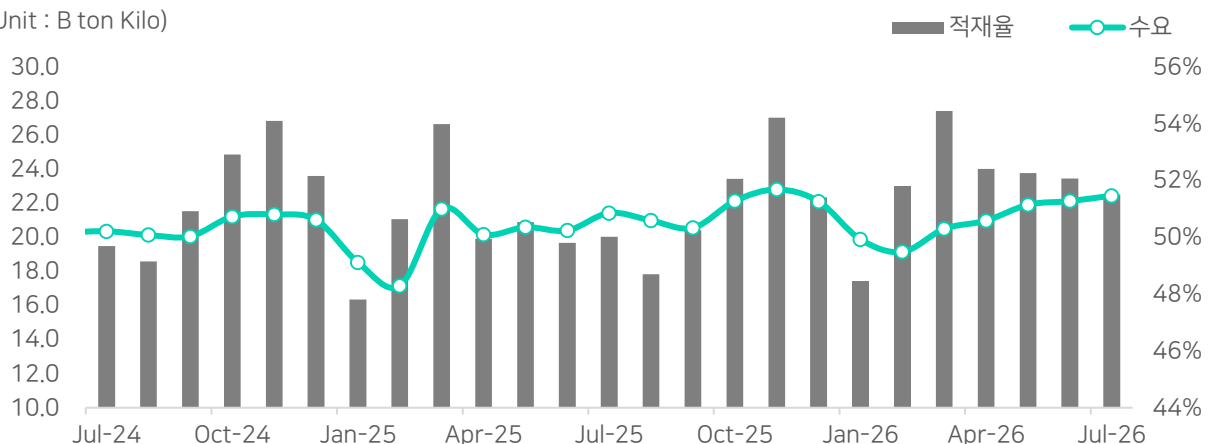
**Partial flight cuts/cancellations briefly reduced Belly capacity*

○ August 2026 Demand Trends²

- Early-August Asia-origin demand dipped temporarily at major airports including Shanghai due to a typhoon, then stabilized gradually from mid-month
- Following the July tariff overhaul-driven decline in Europe-bound e-commerce volume, the drop from China and Hong Kong origins gradually narrowed, while semiconductor/AI server cargo supported overall volume
- August demand trends by major region (origin basis, weeks 33-34)
 - Global demand fell 3% vs prev. 2W and rose 5% YoY, as typical early-to-mid-August slack briefly slowed volume ahead of peak season, though YoY growth held
 - Asia: Down 3.0% vs. prev. 2W and up 4.0% YoY, led by growth in semiconductor/AI server cargo
 - North America: Down 3.0% vs. prev. 2W and up 5.0% YoY, tracking the global trend
 - MEIA: Down 3.0% vs. prev. 2W and up 7.0% YoY, led by India-origin volume
 - Europe: Down 6.0% vs. prev. 2W and up 7.0% YoY; softer e-commerce demand redirected freighter capacity to transpacific lanes, weighing on short-term European volume

[Global Demand and Load Factor]³

(Unit : B ton Kilo)



Month	May	Jun	Jul	MoM	YoY
Load Factor	52.2%	52.0%	51.5%	-0.5%p	+1.4%p
Demand (B ton Kilo)	21.9	22.1	22.5	+1.4%	+4.7%

¹ IATA, Air Cargo Market Analysis

² WorldACD

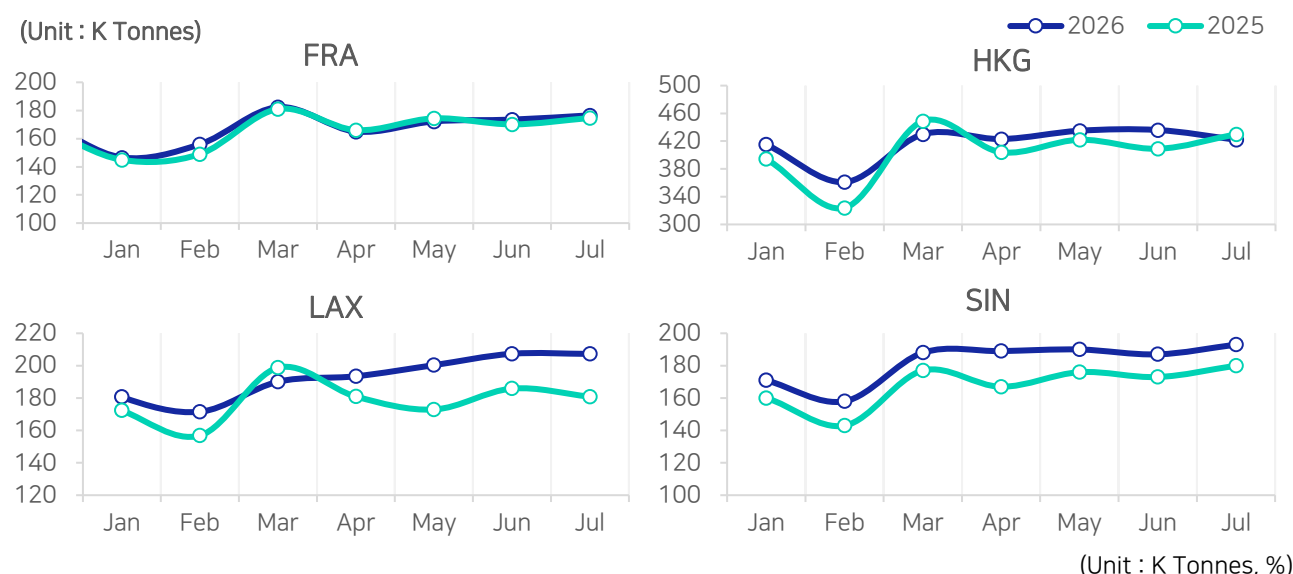
³ IATA, Monthly statistics



Major Airport Cargo Throughput

- Frankfurt Airport (FRA)
 - July 2026 cargo throughput reached 176.6K tons, up 1.1% YoY
 - Europe-Asia volume held steady, but Middle East rerouting kept long-haul supply recovery limited
 - Higher passenger flights drove a clear Belly Cargo recovery, lifting passenger-side throughput
- Hong Kong International Airport (HKG)
 - July 2026 cargo throughput reached 422K tons, down 1.9% YoY
 - H1 volume rose 4% YoY, but July volume fell as weaker Europe-bound e-commerce cargo took full effect
 - Transfer/transshipment passengers grew by double digits, while cargo moved opposite on softer e-commerce/Europe-bound demand
- Los Angeles International Airport (LAX)
 - July 2026 cargo throughput reached 207.3K tons, up 14.6% YoY
 - East Asia semiconductor and server rack cargo drove transpacific demand, key to West Coast volume growth
 - Semiconductor/electronics cargo stayed resilient despite tighter U.S. import customs enforcement
- Singapore Changi Airport (SIN)
 - July 2026 cargo throughput reached 193K tons, up 7.2% YoY
 - Changi sustained near-double-digit Q2 growth, led by semiconductor/electronics cargo
 - A new cargo facility and express carrier hub launched in August, strengthening its transshipment position

[Major Airport Cargo Throughput]⁴



Month	Frankfurt Airport		Hong Kong Intl. Airport		Los Angeles Intl. Airport		Singapore Changi Airport	
	Volume	YoY(%)	Volume	YoY(%)	Volume	YoY(%)	Volume	YoY(%)
May-26	172.3	-1.2%	435.0	+3.1%	200.3	+15.8%	190.0	+8.0%
Jun-26	173.5	+2.0%	436.0	+6.6%	207.3	+11.6%	187.0	+8.1%
Jul-26	176.6	+1.1%	422.0	-1.9%	207.3	+14.6%	193.0	+7.2%

⁴ CAPA, Data Centre



Supply Trends

○ July 2026 Supply Trends⁵

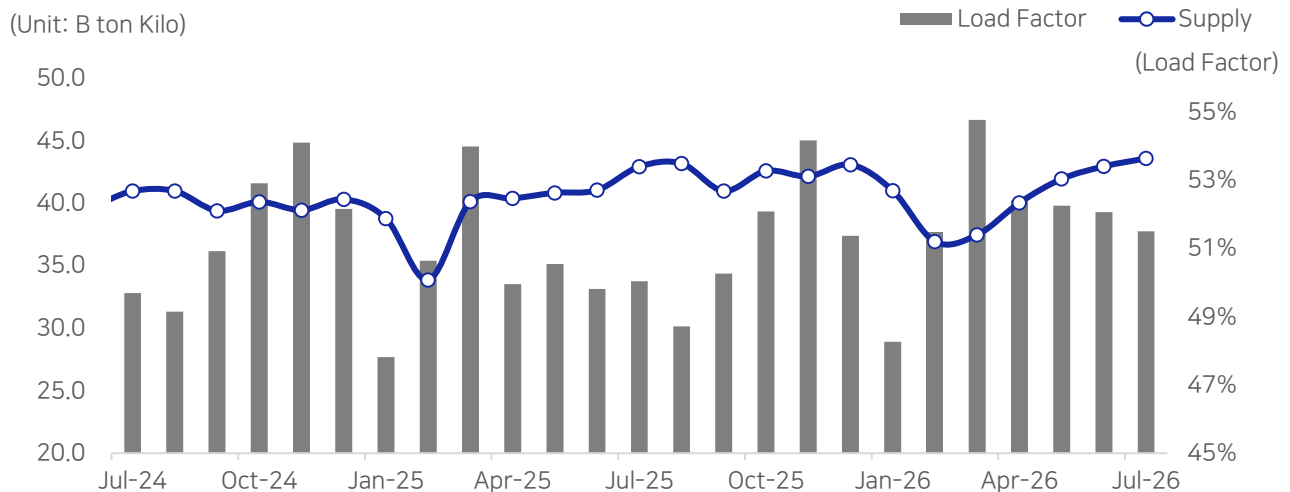
- July supply increased 1.8% YoY (up 2.4% MoM)
- Supply growth trailed demand, though the supply-demand gap narrowed MoM, gradually easing
 - * Demand growth 4.7%
 - * Gap narrowed from 4.5%p (Jun) to 2.9%p (Jul)
- Asia-Pacific carriers accounted for about 74% of the total increase, while N.A carrier supply fell about 1.5%
 - * ~0.54B ton- km

○ August 2026 Supply Trends⁶

- August supply rose 0.4% YoY, growing alongside semiconductor/AI demand (up 0.3% MoM)
- Supply share: passenger aircraft 43%, freighters 38%, express carriers 19%; Belly capacity growth continued
 - Supply changes YoY: passenger aircraft flat, freighters up 1.3%, express carriers down 0.4%
 - Passenger supply rose 1.8% MoM on summer holiday travel demand but was flat YoY; August supply growth was led by freighter expansion
- August supply trends by major region⁷
 - By region, YoY: Asia-origin up 2%, North America-origin up 2%, Europe flat, MEIA up 4%
 - Asia-origin supply expanded mainly on East Asia-N.A lanes, with added Taiwan/Incheon freighter capacity on semiconductor/AI server demand
 - EU-bound supply was flat YoY but fell 1% vs prev. 2W on China/HK freighter cuts, leaving a perceived shortage
 - N.A-origin supply had already exceeded pre-conflict M.E airspace levels but eased slightly on recent seasonal slack
 - M.E-origin supply is normalizing slowly on Gulf routes, while South Asia-origin supply expanded sharply, centered on Bengaluru Airport, India's hub for IT, electronics, and pharmaceutical export cargo

* India freighter growth: BLR +48%, DEL +8%, BOM +13%, MAA +33%

[Global Supply and Load Factor]⁸



Month	May	Jun	Jul	MoM	YoY
Load Factor	52.2%	52.0%	51.5%	-0.5%p	+1.4%p
Supply (B ton Kilo)	42.0	42.5	43.6	+2.4%	+1.8%

⁵ IATA, Air Cargo Market Analysis

⁶ Seabury

⁷ WorldACD

⁸ IATA, Monthly statistics



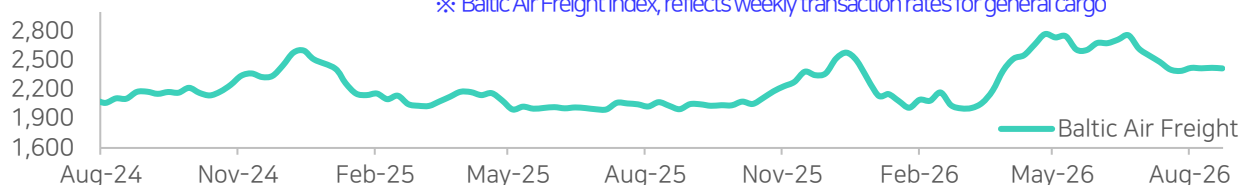
3. Air Market Outlook & Freight Index Trends

Air Freight Composite Index and Route Trend Analysis

- The week 35 Baltic Air Freight Index reached 2,419, down 0.2% WoW and up 21.0% YoY
- Aug. average index was 2,422 (-1.5% MoM, +19.1% YoY), extending high rates in the off-peak season
- August rates steadied after July's decline, moving in a narrow range; ME risk and firm jet fuel supported the rate floor

[Air Freight Composite Index]⁹

※ Baltic Air Freight Index, reflects weekly transaction rates for general cargo



※ MoM, YoY: based on monthly

Week	W32	W33	W34	W35	WoW(%)	Aug. Avg	MoM(%)	YoY(%)
BAI00	2,424	2,420	2,425	2,419	-0.2%	2,422	-1.5%	+19.1%

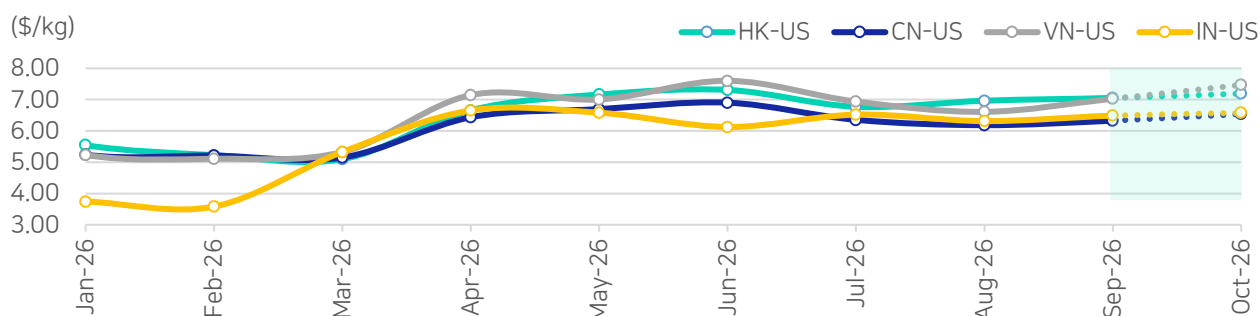
- August Air Cargo Market Trends by Key Region
 - North America-bound rates saw a partial upturn on semiconductor demand with minimal declines, while Europe-bound rates fell more sharply MoM
 - North America-bound rates were relatively resilient, up 2.8% from Hong Kong and down just 3.0% from Shanghai, while China/Hong Kong-origin Europe-bound rates fell 2.1-8.7% MoM
 - On India-origin lanes, ME airspace restrictions and rerouting kept YoY rates up 50-80% across all lanes since May
 - August India-origin average rates rose 54.3% YoY to N.A and 60.4% to EU, the largest increases among major lanes

* August average (W32-W35)

Samsung SDS Short Term Forecast

- September rates likely to stay high on N.A-bound lanes, driven by strong Asia semiconductor demand
- Air freight rates likely to steady and edge up slightly on China/HK-Europe recovery and peak-season effects
 - Peak-season China/HK-origin rates may rebound, with rising freighter utilization on Asia-N.A lanes supporting the floor
 - N.A-bound rates likely to stay firm on continued semiconductor volume from Taiwan and Korea
 - EU-bound volume declines from softer e-commerce may ease as pre-National Day rush shipments arrive

[Samsung SDS TAC Forecast]¹⁰



⁹ TAC index

¹⁰ Samsung SDS Brightics

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U.S. Tariff Policy: A Quick Overview

Registration date | AUG 20, 2026

[Tariff Summary by Country](#)

Category	date	Details of Tariff Policies
Trade Enforcement Tariffs	2026.08.18	3-Day Suspension of Additional Duties Under Section 338 of the Tariff Act in Response to Canada's Discriminatory Trade Measures - 3-day suspension of additional duties in consideration of Canada's expressed commitment to remove the discriminatory measures and ongoing bilateral negotiations - Effective date changed from Aug. 19 to Aug. 22

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